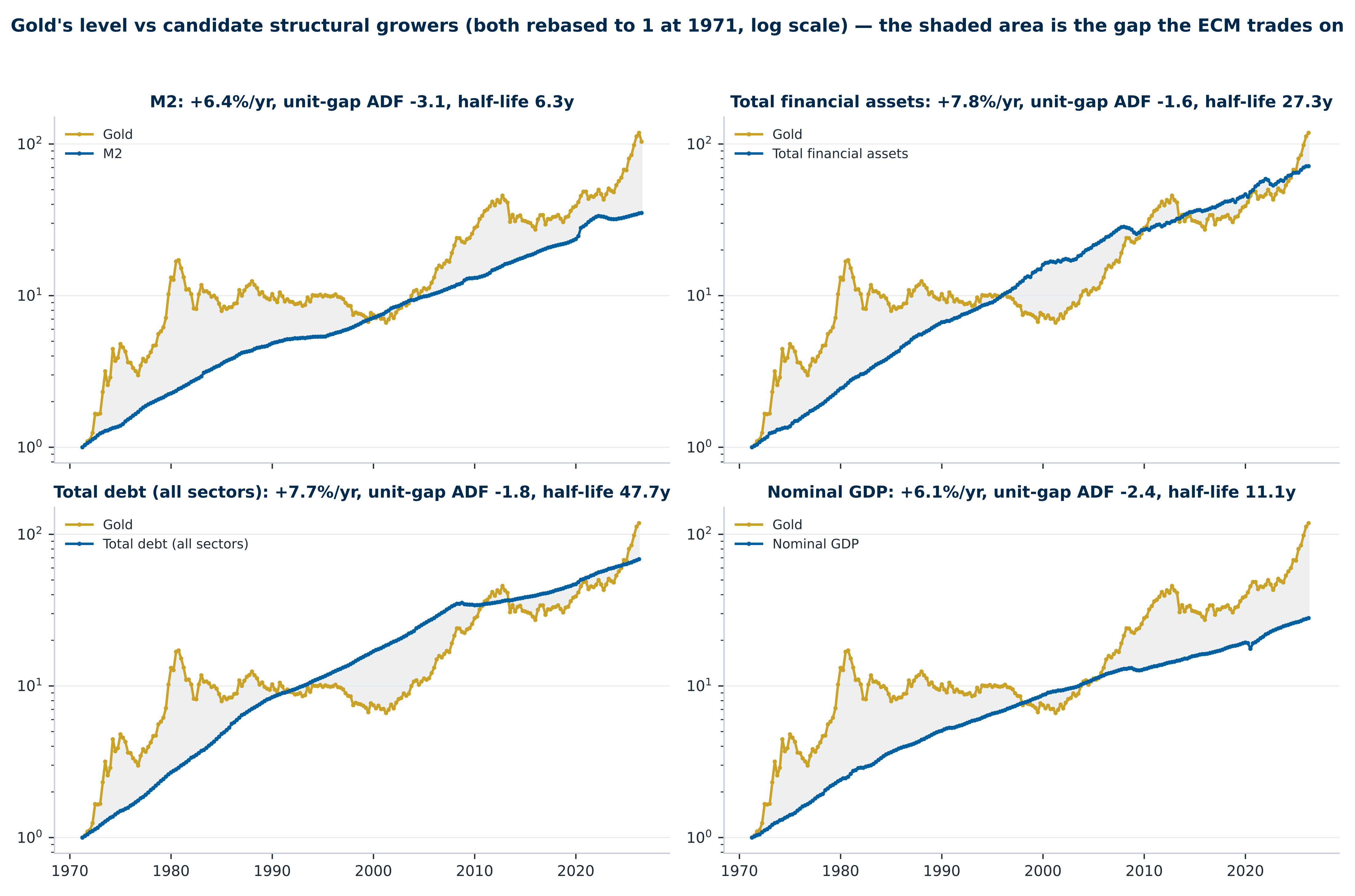
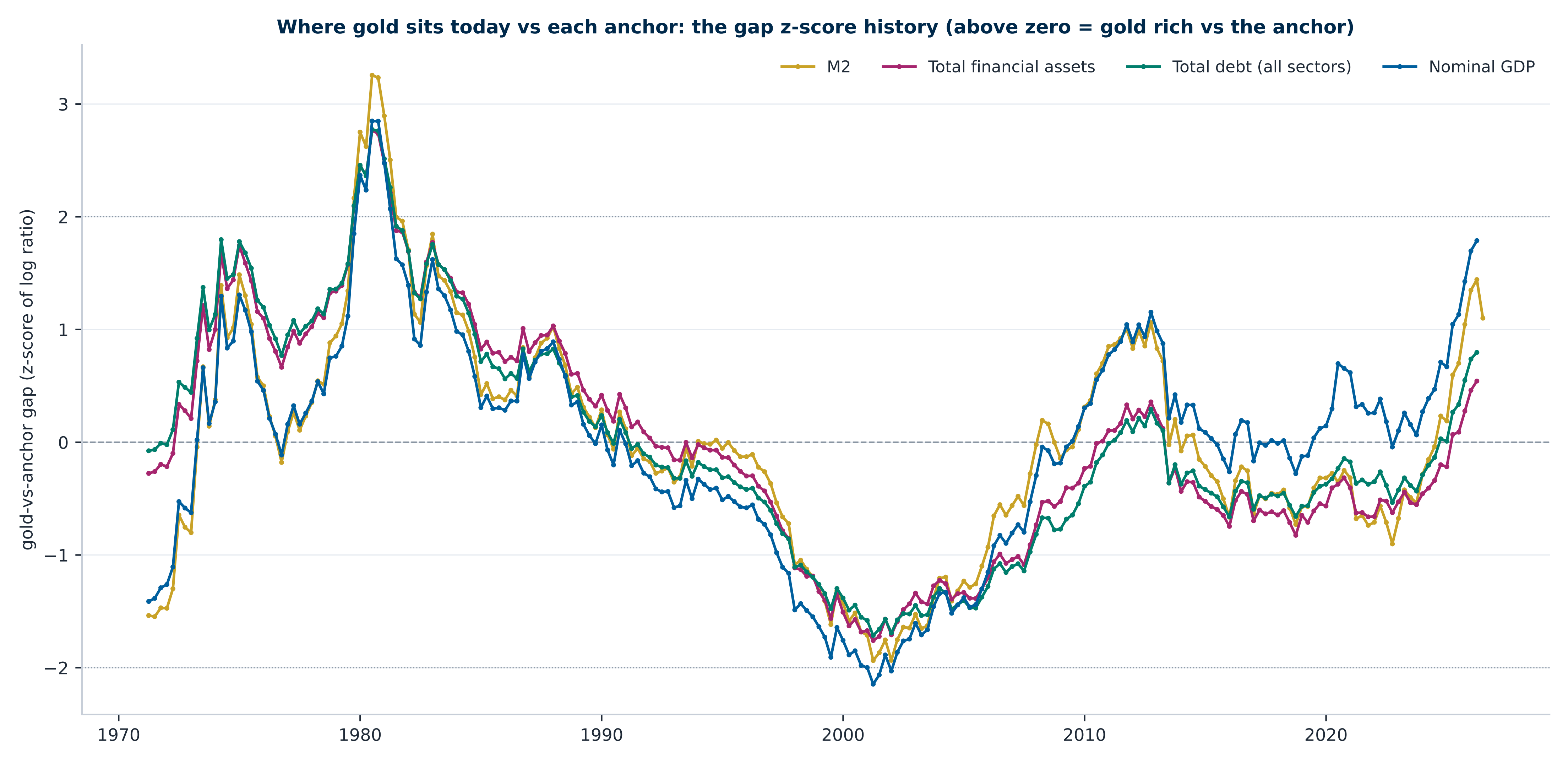
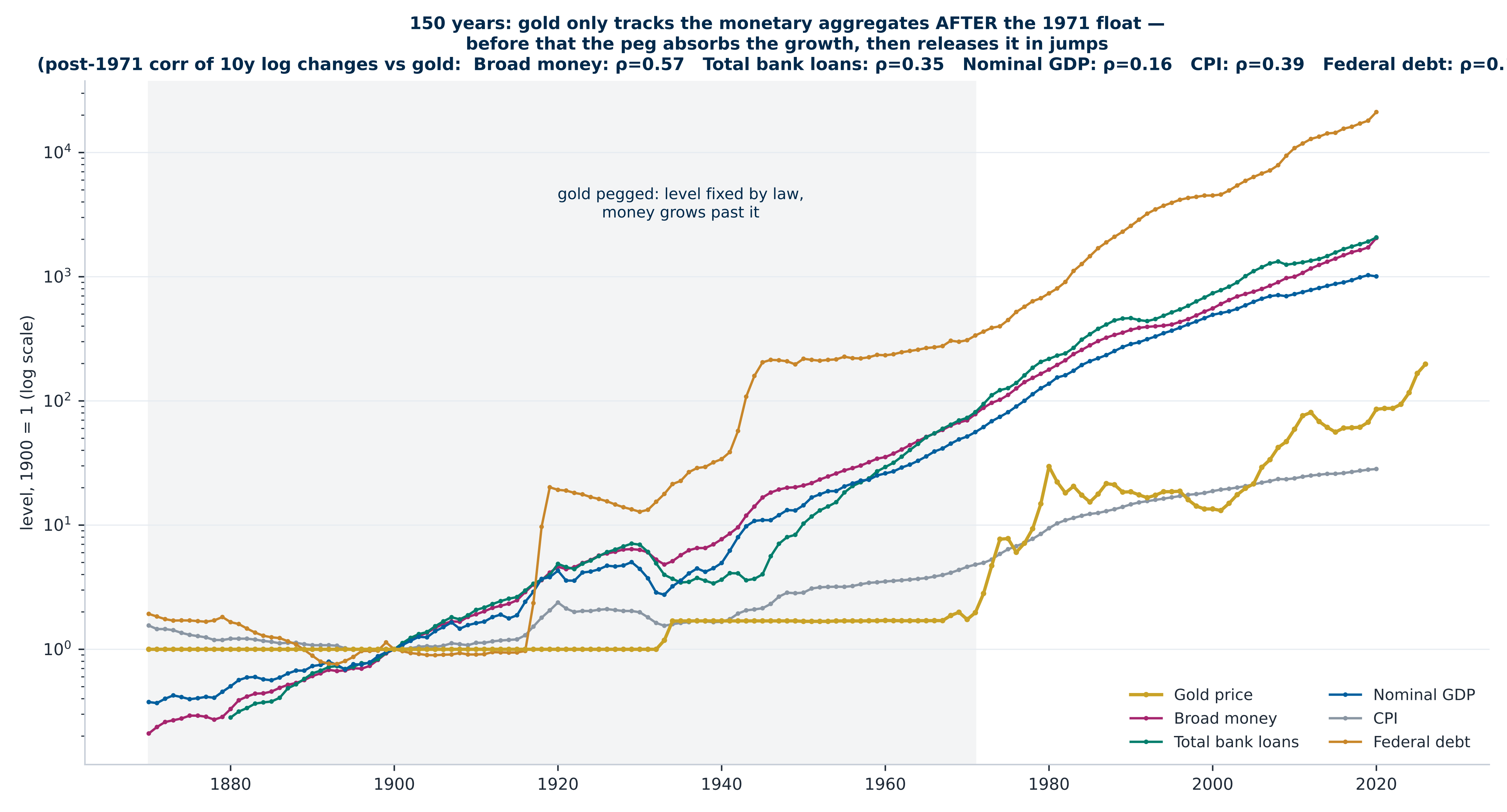
Which structural grower is gold tethered to? Quarterly log levels, 1971Q1–2026Q2 (gold drift +8.4%/yr)
λ = reversion speed toward the anchor; 'independent episodes' = full reversion cycles the sample holds — the levels-space small-n problem, quantified

Anchor	Growth %/yr	Coint. ADF t (fitted / unit)	λ per qtr (t)	λ t with factors	Half-life (yrs)	Indep. episodes	Gap now (% / z)	Drift pull next 10y %/yr
M2	+6.4	-3.35 / -3.10	-2.7% (-1.1)	-1.1	6.3	4.4	+45 / +1.1	-3.0
Monetary base	+7.6	-2.96 / -1.50	-1.1% (-0.8)	+0.5	15.1	1.8	-6 / -0.1	+0.2
CPI	+3.8	-2.32 / -1.48	-1.7% (-1.1)	-0.5	10.0	2.8	+124 / +2.4	-6.2
Nominal GDP	+6.1	-2.40 / -2.37	-1.5% (-0.8)	-0.5	11.1	2.5	+81 / +1.8	-3.7
Total debt (all sectors)	+7.7	-2.18 / -1.78	-0.4% (-0.2)	-0.4	47.7	0.6	+50 / +0.8	-0.7
Federal debt	+8.4	-2.78 / -1.89	-0.2% (-0.2)	-0.9	69.7	0.4	+6 / +0.1	-0.1
Total financial assets	+7.8	-2.48 / -1.63	-0.6% (-0.4)	-0.8	27.3	1.0	+34 / +0.5	-0.8
Household net worth	+6.9	-2.67 / -2.06	-1.3% (-0.7)	-1.1	13.1	2.1	+48 / +0.9	-2.0



Gold's level vs candidate structural growers (both rebased to 1 at 1971, log scale) — the shaded area is the gap the ECM trades on
M2: +6.4%/yr, unit-gap ADF -3.1, half-life 6.3y
Total financial assets: +7.8%/yr, unit-gap ADF -1.6, half-life 27.3y
Total debt (all sectors): +7.7%/yr, unit-gap ADF -1.8, half-life 47.7y
Nominal GDP: +6.1%/yr, unit-gap ADF -2.4, half-life 11.1y
Gold
M2
Total financial assets
Total debt (all sectors)
Nominal GDP


Where gold sits today vs each anchor: the gap z-score history (above zero = gold rich vs the anchor)
M2
Total financial assets
Total debt (all sectors)
Nominal GDP
gold-vs-anchor gap (z-score of log ratio)
3
2
1
0
−1
−2
1970
1980
1990
2000
2010
2020



150 years: gold only tracks the monetary aggregates AFTER the 1971 float —
before that the peg absorbs the growth, then releases it in jumps
(post-1971 corr of 10y log changes vs gold: Broad money: ρ=0.57 Total bank loans: ρ=0.35 Nominal GDP: ρ=0.16 CPI: ρ=0.39 Federal debt: ρ=0.
gold pegged: level fixed by law,
money grows past it
level, 1900 = 1 (log scale)
Gold price
Broad money
Total bank loans
Nominal GDP
CPI
Federal debt
1880
1900
1920
1940
1960
1980
2000
2020